SATHISH KUMAR



(From left) **Megha Asher,** *Co-founder and COO, Juicy Chemistry;* **Nalini Parthiban**, *Co-founder and CEO, Sweet Karam Coffee*

because of the vulnerabilities and disadvantages they suffer from a socio-cultural context. "There is something called the environtome which is basically the larger environment, and that's where we need to look at policies, programmes that actually help women attain an equitable and fair playing field," said Murthy. Women are also 'internalisers', which means they are more likely to keep things to themselves and not easily express them, she added. It only emphasises the need to teach them how to cope better, be more resilient and how to look after their own mental state.

For Nigar Shaji, director of the Aditya L1 solar mission, there will always be those who try to undermine a woman's authority. "...By your mettle and your knowledge, you show them you need to be respected.... Self-belief goes a long way in pursuing your passion and achieving your goals." In science, Prof. Annapurni Subramaniam noted, it's doubly harder for women, who have less time than their male counterparts to have higher degrees and work in publications, given that they have to contend with "family formative years". To bring women back into the workforce after motherhood, organisations need to be considerate, allowing them to bring children to office or work from home so they can divide their time.

Actress Pooja Hegde who, at one point, delivered six back-to-back blockbusters and has worked with the biggest superstars in Tamil, Telugu and Hindi cinema, said there needs to be more films written for women. "It's a chicken and egg story where you say there's no audience, but until you make films, how are you going to have the audience?" she asks.

It was not all talk. Sairam and Nataraj joined forces to regale audiences with a soulful performance of *'Krishna nee begane baaro'*, drawing a standing ovation. Hegde shook a leg not once but thrice as she was joined by fans on stage to recreate the iconic steps of tracks like *'Arabic kuthu'* and *'Butta bomma'*. All in all, the summit captured the essence of the female spirit. ■

▲ WHAT WILL IT TAKE TO PROMOTE WOMEN ENTREPRENEURSHIP?

TAKEAWAYS

"As clichéd as it might sound, there are no shortcuts. You'll have to do the dirty work, and learn every single aspect of your business. Knowing every little detail is important; otherwise, your business is not going to succeed as you expect"

Megha Asher

"Entrepreneurship is never a comfortable journey. So, get comfortable with being uncomfortable every day. Problems will arise from all directions. However, view them as challenges coming from all directions. You need to be a solution-finder, not a problem-seeker"

Nalini Parthiban